

**EFFECTS OF THE INCREASING POPULARITY OF
DIGITAL ARTS ON THE CURRENT JOB
MARKET FOR FREELANCE ARTISTS**

A research

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ABSTRACT

*Belecina, A., Muñoz, K., Castro, V. 2023. **EFFECTS OF THE INCREASING POPULARITY OF DIGITAL ARTS ON THE CURRENT JOB MARKET FOR FREELANCE ARTISTS.** Undergraduate of Doña Francisca Lacsamana de Ortega Memorial National High School, La Union Campus, Arts and Design strand, Bangar, La Union.*

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The purpose of this study is to seek the answer of the effect of the increasing popularity of digital art on current jobs for freelance artists. This study is divided into three sections, each being affected by digital art on the current job for freelance artists which is the income, productivity, and skill acquisition of artists. The research questions concerned the use of questionnaires whether implementation finds the effect of increasing the popularity of digital on current jobs for freelance artists. It also seeks the significant difference in the effect of the increasing popularity when grouped according to; age, sex, and occupation.

The finding of the study were Freelance artists that aged 21-30 and 31-40 is dominant in the pie chart that means Freelance artists in BANGAR are mostly in the early adulthood stage. Male takes most of our respondents with 93.3% of 15 respondents, 73% were teachers. Digital art benefits freelance artists in storing their artwork as it can be stored as data easily. And in general the effect of the increasing popularity of digital art on current job for freelance artists' does not influence by several demographic factors such as age, sex, and occupation.

Key words: Digital art, Income, Productivity, Skill Acquisition

Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

The purpose of this study is to seek the answer of the effect of the increasing popularity of digital art on current jobs for freelance artists. This study is divided into three sections, each being affected by digital art on the current job for freelance artists which is the income, productivity, and skill acquisition of artists. The research questions concerned the use of questionnaires on Bangar freelance artists and whether implementation finds the effect of increasing the popularity of digital on current jobs for freelance artists. It also seeks the significant difference in the effect of the increasing popularity when grouped according to; age, sex, and occupation.

In recent years, the world of art has undergone a profound transformation, fueled by the rapid advancement of digital technology. Traditional art forms are no longer confined to physical mediums like canvas and clay. Instead, artists are embracing digital tools and techniques to create captivating works of art. This shift has given rise to a burgeoning field known as digital art, which has gained immense popularity among freelance artists. In this article, we will explore the increasing popularity of digital arts in the current job market for freelance artists.

One of the primary reasons for the growing popularity of digital arts is the vast array of technological advancements that have propelled this medium forward. Digital tools and software have become increasingly accessible, enabling authors to venture beyond the limitations of traditional mediums and embrace the possibilities of digital creation.

The increasing popularity of digital arts has also had a profound impact on the distribution and accessibility of artistic works. With the advent of digital platforms, artists can now easily share their creations with a global audience, transcending geographical boundaries and reaching individuals who may have otherwise remained disconnected from the art world. Through websites, social media, and digital galleries, real authors can showcase their digital creations to a vast online community, fostering engagement and expanding their reach in ways that were once unimaginable.

More and more types of digital art emerge as technology advances. Today, digital art has become a part of daily life and greatly impacts traditional art although many digital artists started learning traditional art. Compared to traditional art, the most significant advantage of digital art is its convenience: digital art is easy to carry, easy to publish and share, easy to be printed in many places, and most importantly, easy to be corrected.

In its broadest extant sense, “digital art” refers to art that relies on computer-based digital encoding, or on the electronic storage and processing of information in different formats—text, numbers, images, sounds—in a common binary code. The ways in which art-making can incorporate computer-based digital encoding are extremely diverse.

For any artwork, appreciation begins with recognition of its status as a *work*, the product of an artistic activity of some kind, and thus something to be appreciated as the achievement of an artist or group of artists. Most commonly, this achievement is understood in terms of the aesthetically significant effects achieved by an artist with certain kinds of tools and materials and in light of certain appreciative conventions.

A work's display is rendered merely contingent by the fact that it is generated from a common code. By adding a particular instruction to the code sequence specifying a work, imagery associated with that work could be instantaneously converted into sounds or text, or just into different imagery. This possibility alone supposedly renders meaningless all talk of an artwork being in a particular medium and being properly appreciated in terms of that medium (Kittler 1999; Doane 2007).

It has always been the case, for example, that “any medium can be translated into any other” (Kittler 1999: 1): without using a computer, someone could manually devise a set of rules (an algorithm) for the translation of image values, say, into sounds or text. Moreover, a common storage and transmission means for (moving) imagery and sound is not unique to digital technology: As Doron Galili points out (2011), electronic image transmission going back to the late nineteenth century—in other words, precursors of the TV—relies on the conversion of both images and sound into electronic pulses.

The style and theme of art is always in a state of constant evolution. However, how it is presented and consumed has always been the same – in the physical world, whether through exhibits or actual performances. The emergence of blockchain technology and Web3, however, has resulted in a new way of enjoying and owning different art forms through non-fungible tokens or NFTs.

NFTs are designed as a way for digital files to be secured in a way that ensures ownership and creates scarcity. Like physical art, an NFT can be sold but the artist can retain the copyright, or they can offer it to the buyer, or

decide on a percentage of secondary sales an owner can have. This is a boon for any artist, but navigating this new scene can be daunting for many.

To help artists understand what NFTs are and how it can be used by them, this year's Pilipinas Shell's Shell National Students Art Competition (NSAC) Virtual Art Interact Sessions brought together NFT artists Jopet Arias and NSAC alumni Aldrine Alarcon to discuss their experience with NFTs as well as how to create one's own NFTs.

The Philippines has a vibrant and growing community of digital artists who showcase their work through various online platforms and social media channels. Many Filipino artists have gained recognition both locally and internationally for their skillful and innovative digital artworks.

The increasing accessibility of digital tools and platforms, as well as the growing interest in digital art, have made it easier for artists in smaller towns and communities to create and share their work. Social media platforms like Instagram, Facebook, and online art communities provide artists with opportunities to showcase their digital art to a wider audience, regardless of their location.

However, the local art scene in Bangar, La Union might be influenced by factors such as the size of the community, the presence of art institutions, and the availability of art events and exhibitions. If Bangar has active art organizations, art schools, or galleries that promote and showcase various forms of art, including digital art, it could contribute to the popularity and recognition of digital art in the local community. To get more specific information about the popularity of digital art in Bangar, La Union, it would be helpful to reach out to local artists, art organizations, or art enthusiasts in

the area. They would have a better understanding of the local art scene and the reception of digital art within the community.

Theoretical Framework

This study is divided into three sections, each were affected by digital art according to several authors. The first one talks about on how the increasing popularity of digital art impacts the income of artists in US. The second section which is the positive and negative effect of digital art on productivity of artists, reports the action/behavior of artist using digital art. Lastly, It describes the importance of digital art in skill acquisition/ Education.

In the findings of Vivian wang and Dali wang, around 75 K artist jobs with a salary of over 60 K are available. Among these job postings, around 33% are higher-paid jobs with a salary of over 100 K. Most of these artist jobs are related to digital art. The job function data analysis showed that the majority (65%) of these artist jobs are related to information technology. The most popular digital art jobs are related to graphics.

These artist jobs are decent and well-paid, which means that there is no need for a second job. Specifically, the majority (65%) of the artist jobs (with a salary of over 60 K) are related to IT and digital art. Also, 85% of the artist jobs are created in the IT and marketing/entertainment industries. Therefore, the increasing popularity of digital art has a significant impact on the income of artists, especially these high-paid jobs.

An author called Cleo and a Flemish student living in Leuven, Cultural Studies at the KU Leuven and I'm taking the course Online Publishing, which is why he posted this blog about the effect digital arts.

According to his blog, digital arts is faster than traditional media. When painting an aquarelle for example, you will need all kinds of tools like paper, water, paint, paintbrushes, tissues. It takes time to prepare all of this and it takes time to maintain all of the tools. When painting digitally, you don't need to worry about your water turning a funky color, or your paintbrush accidentally falling on your painting. Thus, it affects the productivity as it saves time from preparing tools unlike traditional art.

On the other hand, Digital art being more efficient than traditional art, it is also a disadvantage because it takes away the magical feeling while working on a painting or a drawing done by hand. When working traditionally, you're creating something tangible and real with flaws, digital art takes this authentic feeling away for the most part. It is in the progress of an artwork that the real magic happens. Imperfection is what makes traditional art so valuable and charming.

According to strategies provided by the World Academy of Science, Engineering and Technology, digital tools allow students to build artistic creativity and "enable old subjects to be treated in new ways" by blending traditional and newer approaches of learning. For example, through digital art, students can choose from a larger variety of colors more quickly and efficiently than in traditional drawing.

Digital art is a creative discipline of the plastic arts, a new trend that emerged around the application of vector and rewarding programs, including works that use essential digital elements in the production or exhibition process, shown on digital media. There are several kinds of digital art, among them photography and digital image, digital sculpture, interactivity, net art and finally generative art.

Digital art encompasses a series of creative disciplines in which digital technology is applied in the production process or in their exhibition. It integrates computer and digital technology, and there is a temptation to distinguish traditional art from digital, pointing out what is technological and what is not. The technology basically consists in an instrument or procedure that enables creation, and in that sense, there is no difference between a brush and a graphic palette, but it is common to find classifications of digital art based on the medium used

Significance of the study

The study will significantly benefit the following;

Artists- The understanding of the effect of increasing popularity of digital art on the current job, will give them a good attitude towards digital art.

Freelance artists- The result of the positive effects of increasing popularity of digital arts will give them motivation on working as freelance artists.

Researchers- The success of this study is a great achievement on the part of the research.

Future researchers- Results of this study will serve as a benchmark for future researchers with their study associating digital art or marketing jobs online.

Moreover, Digital art has revolutionized the creative landscape by providing artists with new tools, platforms, and mediums to express themselves. Artists recognize the need to stay abreast of these advancements to remain relevant and to explore the potential of digital art in enhancing their artworks. With the proliferation of digital media and online platforms, artists are increasingly connecting with their audience through digital channels. Digital art plays a significant role in capturing and sustaining audience attention, as it offers immersive and interactive experiences.

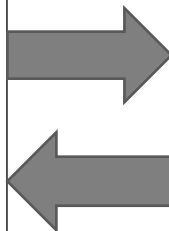
Research Paradigm

Independent Variable

1. The effects of the increasing popularity of digital on the current job of artist;
 - a. Income
 - b. Productivity
 - c. Skill acquisition
2. The significant difference in the effect of the increasing popularity when grouped according to;
 - a. age
 - b. sex, and
 - c. Occupation

Dependent variable

1. Data collection of current artist job market.
2. Artists' job market sampling.
3. Artists' job market data analysis.



Definition and terms

Digital art- Digital art refers to any artistic work or practice that uses digital technology as part of the creative or presentation process. It can also refer to computational art that uses and engages with digital media.

Income- Generally refers to the amount of money, property, and other transfers of value received over a set period of time in exchange for services or products.

Productivity- Productivity generally refers to the ability of an individual, team, or organization to work efficiently within that time in order to maximize output.

Skill Acquisition- It is a culmination of movement mechanics, physical literacy, biomechanics, athletics development, psychology and coaching practice. The development of skill, and the ability to learn, improve and develop performance, is central to sport and physical activity.

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the effects of increasing popularity of artwork on big data as marketing job for artists.

Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents according to
 - a. age
 - b. sex, and
 - c. Occupation
2. What are the effects of the increasing popularity of digital on the current job of artist;
 - a. Income
 - b. Productivity
 - c. Skill acquisition
3. Is there a significant difference in the effect of the increasing popularity when grouped according to;
 - a. age
 - b. sex, and
 - c. Occupation

Statement of the Hypothesis

There is no significant difference in the effects of the increasing popularity of digital arts on market jobs for freelance artists when grouped according to age, sex and Occupation.

Chapter 2

Research Methodology

Research design

This research provided a descriptive-comparative method to describe the impact of the rising popularity of digital art on the national job market for artists today.

According to Best (2008), the descriptive method involves describing, analyzing, and interpreting conditions that exist. It also includes some types of comparisons, contrast, and attempt to discover the relationship between existing non-manipulative variables. It is concerned with the conditions of relationships that exist, opinions that are held, processes that are going on, or trends that are for development.

Research Environment

Here is a short history and origin of Bangar, La Union according to wikipedia

The locations of artist were in Bangar, La union. Bangar, officially the Municipality of Bangar (Ilocano: Ili ti Bangar; Filipino: Bayan ng Bangar), is a 3rd class municipality in the province of La Union, Philippines. According to the 2020 census, it has a population of 38,041 people.

The name Bangar derives from the *bangar* tree (*Sterculia foetida*), which was once abundant in the general area of the present town. The bangar tree is notable for the foul odor that emanates from its flowers.

Bangar is famous for its loom-weaving industry. The big bulk of orders for placemats, towels, draperies, curtains, blankets and even bathrobes from

all over the country and even abroad speaks well of the quality of Bangar woven products.

The year 1700 marked the official foundation of Bangar under the patronage of Saint Christopher when it became a ministry. However, Christianity was brought as early as in the later part of 1500 when Bangar was still a visita of Tagudin. The book *Historia Agustiniana* which was authored by Fr. Isacio R. Rodriguez stated that the massive church was started in 1696 and was finished in 1697 by Fr. Francisco Alvear, a learned Spanish Augustinian priest born in Liaño Santander, Spain. He died in Bangar in 1698.

Through the “Superior Decreto” (executive decree) signed by Governor General Antonio Maria Blanco on March 2, 1850, the town of Bangar was made a part of La Union, the newly created province. Before 1850, Bangar, Purao (Balaoan) and Namacpacan (Luna) were parts of Ilocos Sur.

Respondents

This study used a purposive sampling that fits the character of digital artists and freelancers. It includes 15 of digital freelancers of Bangar, La Union.

Distribution and Frequency

Participants	Frequency	Percentage	Population
Freelance Artists	15	100%	15

Data Gathering Tool

The data gathering tool used in this study was the questionnaire, it consists of 24 questions with 4 scales that indicate the rate on how much they agree or disagree to the effects of the increasing popularity of digital art.

It is a Likert type of questionnaire. A Likert scale is a psychometric scale commonly involved in research that employs questionnaires. It is the most widely used approach to scaling responses in survey research, such that the term is often used interchangeably with rating scale, although there are other types of rating scales.

This questionnaire is approved by professionals giving our questionnaire a score value of 4.5.

Data Gathering procedure

With people's consent, this way, this study conducted a survey to get responses that are relevant to what we're looking for, in our data collection, it was linked into a monitoring service, it means it is already gathering data the moment someone our survey post through LinkedIn and Upwork.

After the valid consent for gathering the data, the finding of sample will start, we'll make sure to know how they feel about the study and acknowledge it, in other words students who's willing to answer our questions in the questionnaire will serve as our respondents.

To be sure of a one hundred percent retrieval, we will personally administer the questionnaire with the aid of the class advisors.

After a retrieval, the set of questionnaire will then be coded ready for data processing.

Statistical treatment of data

The statistical tool that will be utilized in the treatment of data for problem number 1 and 2 on the demographic profile of digital freelancers and the effects of increasing popularity on current job for freelance artists, were weighted mean and ranking.

The computation of the mean value will be done by multiplying the raw scores by the numerical weight in each column on 4-3-2-1 scale of values, adding the products obtained and dividing the sum by the total replies for a specific item.

For the problem number 3 if there are significant differences in the order of intelligences when analyzed into type of strand and year level, t-test and anova will be used. The formula is:

$$t = \frac{m - u}{s/\sqrt{n}}$$

$$F = \frac{M_{ssb}}{M_{ss}}$$

Where

Where F=f-value

t= Respondent's t-test

M_{ssb}=mean of squares between column

m=mean

M_{ss}=mean of squares within column

u=theoretical value

s=standard deviation

n=variable set size